

Powerful meteorites

There have been a number of spectacular meteorite strikes on our planet.



A meteorite strike in **Tunguska, Siberia** destroyed miles of forest in 1908.



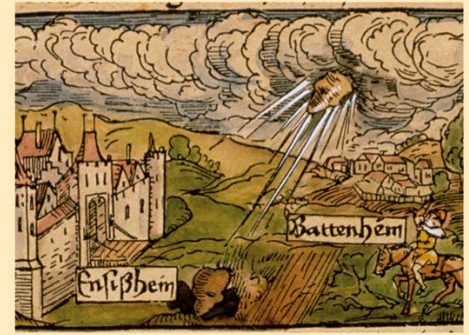
The **Barringer Crater** in Arizona was formed 50,000 years ago. It is 1,609 m (5,278 ft) across.



Many believe the **dinosaurs** were wiped out by a meteorite strike 65 million years ago.

Fire from the sky

People have feared meteorites for centuries. Some saw them as fiery dragons, others as weapons sent by angry gods.



hands on

See the impact of meteorites by dropping different size balls onto a tray of damp sand. This shows what happens when a meteorite hits a planet's surface – it leaves a crater.

A meteoroid strikes our atmosphere at up to 72 km per second (160,000 mph).

I like you!

Most meteorites will attract a magnet, because of their iron content.



A lone meteor

A meteor that isn't part of a shower is called a sporadic meteor. Incredibly bright meteors are called fireballs.

